Case Study Exercise

Organizing a Company Annual Dinner

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1. Scenario / Instructions

Your company is planning a **Company Annual Dinner** to celebrate employee achievements and strengthen team bonding.

The event will include:

- Venue booking
- Catering and dinner arrangement
- Entertainment and stage program
- Lucky draw and awards
- Event setup and coordination

You have been appointed as the **Project Planner**, and your task is to create the **project schedule using Microsoft Project**.

Participants must:

1. Create a **new project in Microsoft Project**
2. Set the **Project Start Date: 3 August 2026**
3. Enter the **task list and durations**
4. Create the **Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)** by indenting subtasks
5. Link the **task dependencies**
6. Create the **resources and rates**
7. Assign resources to tasks
8. View the **Critical Path**
9. Review the **total project cost**

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2. Detailed Task List

ID	Task Name	Duration
1	Company Annual Dinner Project	
2	Project Planning	

3	Define Event Objectives	2 days
4	Prepare Event Budget	3 days
5	Management Budget Approval	1 day
6	Venue Arrangement	
7	Search Venue Options	3 days
8	Visit Shortlisted Venues	2 days
9	Confirm Venue Booking	1 day
10	Catering Arrangement	
11	Select Catering Vendor	3 days
12	Confirm Menu	2 days
13	Sign Catering Agreement	1 day
14	Event Program Preparation	
15	Plan Event Program	3 days
16	Arrange Lucky Draw Prizes	2 days
17	Prepare Award Categories	2 days
18	Promotion & Invitations	
19	Design Invitation Card	2 days
20	Send Invitations	1 day
21	Confirm Guest Attendance	3 days
22	Event Preparation	
23	Prepare Event Materials	3 days
24	Arrange Stage & Sound System	2 days
25	Event Day	
26	Venue Setup	1 day
27	Run Event Program	1 day
28	Dinner Service	1 day
29	Lucky Draw & Award Ceremony	1 day
30	Project Milestone: Event Completed	0 days

Participants must **indent subtasks properly** to create the WBS structure.

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3. Task Dependencies

Use **Finish-to-Start (FS)** relationships.

Predecessor	Successor	Dependency
Define Event Objectives	Prepare Event Budget	FS
Prepare Event Budget	Management Budget Approval	FS
Management Budget Approval	Search Venue Options	FS
Search Venue Options	Visit Shortlisted Venues	FS
Visit Shortlisted Venues	Confirm Venue Booking	FS
Confirm Venue Booking	Select Catering Vendor	FS
Select Catering Vendor	Confirm Menu	FS
Confirm Menu	Sign Catering Agreement	FS
Management Budget Approval	Plan Event Program	FS
Plan Event Program	Arrange Lucky Draw Prizes	FS
Plan Event Program	Prepare Award Categories	FS
Plan Event Program	Design Invitation Card	FS
Design Invitation Card	Send Invitations	FS
Send Invitations	Confirm Guest Attendance	FS
Confirm Guest Attendance	Prepare Event Materials	FS
Prepare Event Materials	Arrange Stage & Sound System	FS
Confirm Venue Booking	Venue Setup	FS
Arrange Stage & Sound System	Venue Setup	FS
Venue Setup	Run Event Program	FS
Run Event Program	Dinner Service	FS
Dinner Service	Lucky Draw & Award Ceremony	FS
Lucky Draw & Award Ceremony	Event Completed	FS

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4. Resources with Rates

Participants must create the following resources in **Resource Sheet**.

Resource Name	Type	Standard Rate
Project Manager	Work	RM120/hr
HR Team	Work	RM80/hr
Finance Officer	Work	RM90/hr
Admin Staff	Work	RM50/hr
Event Vendor	Work	RM150/hr
Technician	Work	RM100/hr
Volunteers	Work	RM30/hr

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5. Resource Assignment Guide

Participants should assign resources as follows.

Task	Resource
Define Event Objectives	Project Manager
Prepare Event Budget	Finance Officer
Management Budget Approval	Project Manager
Search Venue Options	Admin Staff
Visit Shortlisted Venues	Project Manager
Confirm Venue Booking	Admin Staff
Select Catering Vendor	HR Team
Confirm Menu	HR Team
Sign Catering Agreement	Project Manager
Plan Event Program	HR Team
Arrange Lucky Draw Prizes	HR Team
Prepare Award Categories	HR Team
Design Invitation Card	Admin Staff
Send Invitations	Admin Staff

Confirm Guest Attendance	Admin Staff
Prepare Event Materials	HR Team
Arrange Stage & Sound System	Technician
Venue Setup	Volunteers
Run Event Program	Project Manager
Dinner Service	Event Vendor
Lucky Draw & Award Ceremony	HR Team

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6. Tracking Scenario (Progress Update)

Two weeks after the project started, the project manager receives the following **progress update**.

Participants must update the schedule in **Microsoft Project**.

Step 1 — Set the Baseline

Before entering progress:

Go to:

Project → Set Baseline → Set Baseline

Choose:

Baseline → Entire Project

This allows comparison between **planned vs actual schedule**.

Step 2 — Update Task Progress

Enter the following **actual progress**.

Task	**Status**
Define Event Objectives	100% Complete
Prepare Event Budget	100% Complete
Management Budget Approval	100% Complete
Search Venue Options	100% Complete
Visit Shortlisted Venues	100% Complete
Confirm Venue Booking	100% Complete

Select Catering Vendor	50% Complete
Confirm Menu	Not Started
Sign Catering Agreement	Not Started
Plan Event Program	100% Complete
Arrange Lucky Draw Prizes	50% Complete
Prepare Award Categories	0%
Design Invitation Card	100% Complete
Send Invitations	100% Complete
Confirm Guest Attendance	40% Complete

Step 3 — Unexpected Delay

A problem occurs.

The **Technician informs the team that sound system equipment is not available on time**, causing a delay.

Update the following:

Task	**Update**
Arrange Stage & Sound System	Delayed by 2 days

Participants must update the schedule and observe:

- New **project finish date**
- Changes in the **critical path**

Step 4 — Questions for Participants

After updating the project:

1 Did the **project finish date change**?

2 Which tasks are now on the **Critical Path**?

3 Which task caused the **schedule delay**?

4 What could the project manager do to **recover the schedule**?